

FULL CIRCLE

Pilot Episode

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Drama

PAGE 1

FADE IN:

EXT. ARIZONA NEIGHBORHOOD – DAY

A quiet Arizona neighborhood.

Bright sun. Desert heat. Long sidewalks cutting through an otherwise ordinary residential area.

A MAN'S BOOTS hit the pavement.

Slow.

Steady.

Deliberate.

The camera follows the movement before revealing—

MARK HILL, early 30s.

Black hoodie.

Dark pants.

Work boots.

His hood hangs against his back as he walks alone.

Mark isn't sightseeing.

He knows this neighborhood.

He keeps moving, occasionally looking toward the houses and open spaces surrounding him.

This is familiar territory.

Home.

But Mark carries himself like a man who knows familiarity doesn't always mean safety.

He passes a chain-link fence.

A neighborhood park sits beyond it.

Mark slows.

His phone rests in his hand.

He checks the screen.

Nothing.

He continues walking.

EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD PARK – MOMENTS LATER

Mark enters the park.

Trees provide small patches of shade.

A trash can sits near the walkway.

Beyond it, an open field stretches toward another row of homes.

Mark stops.

Looks around.

He pulls his phone out again.

This time—

He makes a call.

PAGE 2

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – DAY

Floor-to-ceiling windows overlook the city.

The contrast from Mark's neighborhood is immediate.

Modern furniture.

Clean lines.

A laptop sits open on a table.

Near the window stands—

MALCOLM HILL, early 30s.

Same face.

Completely different presentation.

White dress shirt.

Black tie.

Glasses.

Wireless earbuds.

Professional.

Focused.

Malcolm looks down at the city from high above.

His phone rings through his earbuds.

He checks the caller.

MARK.

Malcolm answers.

MALCOLM

What's up?

INTERCUT WITH:

EXT. PARK – DAY

Mark continues walking.

MARK

What you doing?

MALCOLM

Working.

MARK

You always working.

MALCOLM

That's usually how this works.

Mark smirks.

Same Malcolm.

MARK

You got a minute?

Malcolm looks toward his laptop.

MALCOLM

I got a minute.

Mark stops walking.

His tone changes.

MARK

You talked to Michael?

Malcolm turns from the window.

MALCOLM

Not lately.

MARK

How long is lately?

MALCOLM

Why?

Mark looks across the neighborhood.

MARK

Just asking.

MALCOLM

You don't call just to ask questions.

Mark doesn't respond.

Malcolm knows his brother.

MALCOLM

What's going on?

PAGE 3

EXT. PARK – CONTINUOUS

Mark sits.

He leans forward.

MARK

Nothing.

MALCOLM (V.O.)

That's a lie.

Mark smiles.

MARK

You think you know everything.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – CONTINUOUS

Malcolm walks away from the window.

MALCOLM

I know you.

MARK (V.O.)

You used to.

That stops Malcolm.

A beat.

MALCOLM

What's that supposed to mean?

MARK (V.O.)

Exactly what it sounds like.

Malcolm shakes his head.

MALCOLM

Here we go.

EXT. PARK – CONTINUOUS

Mark looks toward the houses surrounding him.

MARK

I'm serious.

MALCOLM (V.O.)

So am I.

MARK

Three brothers.

A beat.

MARK

Three different places.

MALCOLM (V.O.)

That's called growing up.

MARK

Nah.

Mark looks down.

MARK

Growing up ain't the same as growing apart.

Malcolm doesn't immediately respond.

MARK

When was the last time all three of us were in the same room?

Malcolm thinks.

He doesn't have an answer.

Mark knew he wouldn't.

PAGE 4

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT - DAY

Malcolm stands at the window again.

Arizona spreads beneath him.

MALCOLM

Everybody has their own life.

MARK (V.O.)

I know.

MALCOLM

Michael has his.

I have mine.

You've got yours.

MARK (V.O.)

That's the problem.

MALCOLM

How is having a life a problem?

MARK (V.O.)

It ain't.

A beat.

MARK (V.O.)

Forgetting where that life came from is.

Malcolm's expression tightens.

MALCOLM

You calling me for something or you just wanted to give me a speech?

Mark laughs.

MARK (V.O.)

Still can't tell you nothing.

MALCOLM

You can tell me anything.

MARK (V.O.)

Can I?

Silence.

Malcolm looks toward the laptop.

A document is open.

Travel information.

Business notes.

Plans.

His future is being constructed in front of him.

MALCOLM

What do you want, Mark?

EXT. PARK – SAME

Mark looks directly ahead.

MARK

I want my brothers back.

Malcolm wasn't expecting that.

Neither was Mark.

Mark stands.

MARK

Call Michael.

The call ends.

PAGE 5

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – CONTINUOUS

Malcolm lowers his phone.

He looks back at the city.

His reflection stares at him in the glass.

Successful.

Professional.

Alone.

He returns to his laptop.

Tries to work.

Can't.

Malcolm reaches for his phone.

Scrolls through his contacts.

Stops.

MICHAEL HILL.

He considers calling.

Doesn't.

Not yet.

INT. APARTMENT GYM – DAY

DUMBBELLS hit a rack.

MICHAEL HILL, early 30s, finishes a set.

Again—

Same face.

Third life.

Michael wears a white sleeveless shirt and athletic pants.

He sits on an incline bench.

Heavy dumbbells in each hand.

He leans back.

Pushes.

One repetition.

Then another.

No wasted movement.

No conversation.

Just work.

Michael completes the set and sits forward.

Breathing hard.

He checks himself in the mirror.

For a moment, the gym is completely still.

His phone vibrates nearby.

Michael ignores it.

He reaches for another dumbbell.

The phone vibrates again.

Michael looks over.

He grabs it.

MARK – MISSED CALL.

Michael stares at the name.

Then—

MALCOLM – CALLING.

Michael answers.

PAGE 6

MICHAEL

What's up?

INTERCUT WITH:

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – DAY

Malcolm stands near the window.

MALCOLM

You talked to Mark?

Michael wipes sweat from his forehead.

MICHAEL

He called.

MALCOLM

You answer?

MICHAEL

I'm working out.

MALCOLM

That's not what I asked.

Michael sits.

MICHAEL

No.

MALCOLM

Call him.

Michael studies his brother's tone.

MICHAEL

What happened?

MALCOLM

Nothing happened.

MICHAEL

Then why am I calling him?

Malcolm doesn't answer immediately.

MICHAEL

Malcolm.

MALCOLM

He misses us.

Michael almost laughs.

MICHAEL

That's what this is about?

MALCOLM

Apparently.

Michael grabs his water.

MICHAEL

Then he can say that.

MALCOLM

He did.

That surprises Michael.

MICHAEL

Mark said he misses us?

MALCOLM

Not exactly.

MICHAEL

Of course not.

The brothers share a small laugh.

For a moment, the distance disappears.

PAGE 7

Michael's smile fades.

MICHAEL

How is he?

Malcolm thinks.

MALCOLM

He's Mark.

MICHAEL

That's not an answer.

MALCOLM

It's the only one I got.

Michael leans back against the bench.

MICHAEL

Been a while.

MALCOLM

Yeah.

MICHAEL

You still planning on leaving?

Malcolm glances at his laptop.

MALCOLM

That's the plan.

MICHAEL

Thailand?

MALCOLM

Thailand.

Michael nods.

MICHAEL

When?

MALCOLM

Soon.

MICHAEL

Mark know?

MALCOLM

Yeah.

Michael understands more now.

MICHAEL

That's why he's calling.

MALCOLM

Maybe.

MICHAEL

One brother already gone.

Now another one talking about leaving the country.

Malcolm's expression changes.

MALCOLM

You're not gone.

MICHAEL

Depends who you ask.

A beat.

MICHAEL

Call me later.

MALCOLM

You gonna call Mark?

Michael looks at the missed call.

MICHAEL

Yeah.

They hang up.

Michael sits alone in the gym.

PAGE 8

EXT. ARIZONA PARK – DAY

Mark walks toward a covered area.

He stops beneath the shade.

His phone rings.

MICHAEL.

Mark answers immediately.

MARK

Look who decided to call.

INT. APARTMENT GYM – SAME

Michael smiles.

MICHAEL

You called me first.

MARK

And you ignored me.

MICHAEL

I was busy.

MARK

Everybody busy.

MICHAEL

What's up?

Mark leans against the railing.

MARK

Malcolm talk to you?

MICHAEL

Yeah.

MARK

So he told you.

MICHAEL

He told me you're having some kind of midlife crisis.

Mark laughs.

MARK

Man, shut up.

Michael smiles.

There it is.

The old rhythm.

MICHAEL

For real.

What's going on?

Mark becomes quiet.

MARK

Malcolm leaving.

MICHAEL

I know.

MARK

You already left.

Michael's smile disappears.

MICHAEL

Mark—

MARK

I'm not saying it like that.

MICHAEL

It sounds like you're saying it exactly like that.

MARK

I'm saying things changed.

Michael looks around the empty gym.

MICHAEL

Things are supposed to change.

PAGE 9

MARK

Not everything.

Michael says nothing.

MARK

You remember when people couldn't even tell us apart?

Michael smiles faintly.

MICHAEL

They still can't.

MARK

They could now.

That lands differently.

Mark looks across Arizona.

MARK

Just look at us.

Michael considers that.

MARK

Same face.

Three completely different people.

MICHAEL

That's not necessarily bad.

MARK

I didn't say it was.

A beat.

MARK

I just don't want us waking up one day and realizing we don't know each other anymore.

Michael becomes serious.

MICHAEL

That ain't happening.

MARK

You sure?

Michael doesn't answer.

Mark looks down at the ground.

MARK

Exactly.

INT. GYM – SAME

Michael gets up.

He looks at himself in the mirror.

His reflection resembles Mark.

And Malcolm.

But Mark is right.

Their lives don't.

MICHAEL

What do you want to do?

EXT. PARK – SAME

Mark smiles slightly.

Finally.

MARK

Come home.

PAGE 10

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – LATER

Malcolm stands in front of the window.

His tie is loosened.

Earbuds still in.

He looks down at his phone.

A message from Michael:

MARK WANTS US TO COME HOME.

Malcolm types.

WHEN?

Michael responds.

SOON.

Malcolm looks at his laptop.

Thailand plans remain open.

He closes the computer.

Walks through the apartment.

INT. HIGH-RISE BEDROOM – CONTINUOUS

Malcolm removes his tie.

He catches his reflection.

He studies himself.

For years, Malcolm has worked to become his own man.

Different from his brothers.

Different from the neighborhood.

Different from expectations.

But no matter how far he goes—

The face in the mirror still connects him to two other men.

His phone rings.

Mark.

Malcolm answers.

MALCOLM

You recruiting now?

MARK (V.O.)

Michael called you?

MALCOLM

Yeah.

MARK (V.O.)

Good.

MALCOLM

What's the plan?

MARK (V.O.)

We get together.

MALCOLM

That's not a plan.

MARK (V.O.)

That's the whole plan.

Malcolm smiles.

MALCOLM

You haven't changed at all.

MARK (V.O.)

Neither have you.

Malcolm looks at himself.

Maybe that's not true.

PAGE 11

EXT. ARIZONA PARK – DAY

Mark walks again.

The neighborhood moves around him.

A dog barks in the distance.

Cars pass.

People live ordinary lives.

Mark continues talking to Malcolm.

MARK

Before you leave.

MALCOLM (V.O.)

I haven't left yet.

MARK

That's why I'm asking now.

Malcolm goes quiet.

MARK

One day you're here.

Next day you're halfway around the world.

MALCOLM (V.O.)

I'm trying to build something.

MARK

I know.

MALCOLM (V.O.)

Do you?

Mark stops.

MARK

Yeah.

Malcolm wasn't expecting that.

MARK

You always wanted more.

Even when we were kids.

Mark looks around the neighborhood.

MARK

You'd look at this place like there had to be something on the other side of it.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – SAME

Malcolm looks through his window.

MALCOLM

There is.

MARK (V.O.)

I know.

A beat.

MARK (V.O.)

Just don't forget what's on this side.

Malcolm absorbs that.

MALCOLM

When?

MARK (V.O.)

What?

MALCOLM

When are we getting together?

Mark smiles.

PAGE 12

INT. APARTMENT GYM – LATER

Michael resumes his workout.

Dumbbell press.

Controlled breathing.

He completes another set.

His phone vibrates.

A group message.

MARK: WE'RE DOING THIS.

MALCOLM: APPARENTLY.

Michael smiles.

He types:

MICHAEL: WHEN?

Mark responds:

MARK: SOON.

Michael shakes his head.

MICHAEL: THAT IS NOT A TIME.

Malcolm:

MALCOLM: I TOLD HIM THE SAME THING.

Michael laughs.

For the first time, the three brothers are occupying the same space—

Even if it's only a phone screen.

Michael sets the phone down.

He looks at himself in the mirror.

EXT. PARK – SAME

Mark reads the messages.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – SAME

Malcolm reads them too.

Three identical men.

Three locations.

Three lives.

Connected by a single conversation.

PAGE 13

EXT. ARIZONA – LATE AFTERNOON

The sun hangs lower.

Mark walks away from the park.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – LATE AFTERNOON

Malcolm puts his tie back on.

Straightens it.

Returns to the window.

His professional life is waiting.

But his focus has shifted.

He picks up his phone.

Opens a photograph.

Three brothers.

Together.

He studies it.

INT. GYM – LATE AFTERNOON

Michael racks the dumbbells.

His workout is finished.

He sits.

Checks the same group chat.

Nothing new.

Michael types:

MICHAEL: DON'T WAIT UNTIL MALCOLM IS IN THAILAND.

Malcolm replies immediately:

MALCOLM: I'M STILL HERE.

Mark:

MARK: FOR NOW.

Malcolm stares at the message.

Not angry.

Thinking.

He locks his phone.

EXT. ARIZONA WALKWAY – SAME

Mark continues forward.

He puts his phone away.

A slight smile appears.

His brothers answered.

For today, that's enough.

PAGE 14

MONTAGE – THE THREE BROTHERS

— Mark walking through his Arizona neighborhood.

— Michael alone in the gym.

— Malcolm standing high above the city in his white shirt and black tie.

Same face.

Different clothes.

Different surroundings.

Different ambitions.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – DAY

Malcolm returns to his laptop.

The Thailand material remains on screen.

He stares at it.

Then minimizes the window.

Another folder is visible.

FULL CIRCLE.

Malcolm looks at the words.

EXT. ARIZONA – MARK

Mark stops walking.

Looks behind him.

Then forward.

INT. GYM – MICHAEL

Michael puts on his headphones.

Before starting the music, he looks at his phone once more.

INT. HIGH-RISE – MALCOLM

Malcolm's phone lights up.

A new message from Mark.

DON'T FORGET.

Malcolm responds.

I WON'T.

Michael adds:

NONE OF US WILL.

Malcolm looks at the message.

A long beat.

PAGE 15

EXT. ARIZONA – SUNSET

The neighborhood settles into evening.

Mark walks toward home.

INT. GYM – SAME

Michael exits the workout area.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT – SAME

Malcolm stands at the window.

Three brothers ending three very different days.

Yet for the first time in a long time, each is thinking about the same thing.

Family.

INTERCUT – MARK / MICHAEL / MALCOLM

Mark pulls out his phone.

Michael checks his.

Malcolm holds his.

The group conversation remains on all three screens.

Malcolm types:

WHEN WE GET TOGETHER, WE NEED TO TALK.

Michael responds:

ABOUT WHAT?

Malcolm thinks.

Then:

EVERYTHING.

Mark reads it.

His smile disappears.

There is more behind this reunion than nostalgia.

Things haven't been said.

Choices haven't been explained.

Lives have changed.

Mark types:

GOOD.

Michael:

I'M IN.

Malcolm looks at their responses.

Outside his window, Arizona stretches toward the horizon.

Soon, Thailand will be on the other side of it.

But before Malcolm can move forward—

He has to deal with what he is leaving behind.

EXT. ARIZONA – WIDE

Mark disappears down the sidewalk.

INT. GYM

Michael exits.

INT. HIGH-RISE APARTMENT

Malcolm remains at the window.

Three brothers.

One beginning.

Three separate paths.

Now those paths are beginning to turn back toward one another.

CUT TO BLACK.

FULL CIRCLE

END OF FIRST 15 PAGES